



STUDENT INVOLVEMENT

Student Government Association (SGA) Financial Policies Procedures Manual 2025/2026 updated on 9/03/25

Note: This document is intended as a resource for the 2025/2026 SGA organizations to better understand financial procedures. It is not intended as a comprehensive handbook. For more University policies, consult the Student Handbook and the Student Organization Handbook or communicate specific questions to the SGA advisors.

General Information

As noted in the Constitution of the SGA:

"The mission of the Furman Student Government Association (SGA) is to be a proactive governing body that represents Furman's diverse student population and contributes to the positive development of the university community. We are students serving students."

This mission provides guidance for SGA's financial protocols and procedures; the University sees organizations as being created exclusively by and for students, with decision-making and leadership being the sole responsibility of organization members and elected officers. Ideally, students will benefit from the support and wisdom of faculty/staff advisors, but decision-making and implementation still belongs to students. Additionally, as the funds allocated to SGA come from activity fees paid by every student, SGA has an inherent responsibility to be transparent in its finances, follow procedures and guidelines, and ensure that all students have access to benefiting from the ways the organization spends its money.

Students that are noncompliant with University and SGA policies and procedures may cause their Organization to lose access to its budget and spending privileges until all officers attend a training course at the convenience of the Office of Student Involvement.

Important Contacts:

Caroline Orr, SGA Executive Treasurer
Orrca9@furman.edu

Leslie Hoffmann, OSI Business Manager
Advisor to Treasurers
leslie.hoffmann@furman.edu
864.294.2241
request meeting anytime!

Requesting an SGA Budget

During the Spring semester, usually in late March, the SGA Executive Treasurer will send out a email to all Treasurers to initiate the budget process for the next academic year. Each SGA organization that wishes to receive funding for the following academic year must complete the budget request process and meet all deadlines set forth by the SGA Executive Treasurer. Organizations must submit the budget request form via SyncDIN, which includes a report of the previous year's spending and line items with approximate costs for the coming year, including the total amount requested. The form must include any justification for changes in requests and descriptions of proposed events or programs with associated line items. Advisors can offer counsel, but students must make decisions regarding the budget. SGA officers will review the forms in consultation with the SGA advisors and make initial edits and allotments. Preliminary budgets will be determined by early May for the following academic year.

It is important to note that all club and organization budgets are ***unofficial*** until after the academic year has started and enrollment is finalized. Once the Finance department communicates revenue being allotted to SGA, the Treasurer and Finance Committee will determine whether any changes need to be made to the individual club budgets, and then the final budgets will be formally approved by the SGA Executive Council; this all usually happens within 4-5 weeks of the Fall semester starting. The SGA Council consists of the Executive Board, four elected class representatives per class and 5 representatives of at-large Organizations. The President and Parliamentarian (both members of Executive Board) normally do not vote. The SGA Treasurer will inform all clubs of their final budget figures via email, usually by late September.

After August 1st, student organizations CAN utilize their budgets via SyncDIN. ***However, we ask that these expense requests only be for immediate and necessary items that cannot wait until after budgets are finalized.***

Organizations that do not request a budget can still access SGA funds by submitting a NEW MONEY REQUEST. However, there is no guarantee that the SGA Council will be able to approve these or that funds will be available. We highly recommend student organizations follow the budget process and meet deadlines to receive funding.

Using an SGA Approved Budget

When an organization or an SGA council member wishes to spend money from their budget, an elected officer from the organization/class representative must complete one of the 2025-2026 SGA forms in SyncDIN prior to making ANY purchase including P2X, student reimbursements and Bon Appetit catering. **Only student organization officers/SGA council are allowed to submit requests to use budgets.**

The SGA Treasurer and Finance Committee meet weekly to approve purchases. Please see the information below for details on specific forms.

The 25-26 SGA Credit Card Form

When is the form required? Any and every time you plan to use the SGA credit card-online purchases, P2X, in-store purchases, catering not from Bon Appetit. This will be the form you will use most often.

Where is this form located? On SyncDIN, Student Government Association (SGA) page.

How far in advance should I fill out the form and submit? At least 5 business days BEFORE you need to make the purchase.

Do I need to fill this for P2X? YES! P2X should be charged on the credit card-DO NOT ASK P2X TO CHARGE SGA COST CENTER.

Can I fill out one form for all my purchases? NO, you must fill out a form for EACH vendor you are purchasing from.

What if I don't know the exact amount? That is okay, estimate as best you can. If you go over by more than 15%, please let the SGA Treasurer know via email. Please DO NOT make additional purchases without filling out a new form.

Once the form has been approved, the student who was named in the form as the one checking out the SGA credit card in the Office of Student Involvement, Suite 206 in the Trone Center. The card will be on top of the counter by the window, in the purple clipboard box.

Using the SGA Credit Card

- Only make the purchases that you requested and had approved. Any expenses that you did not include, even if they relate to the same event or need, require a new form.
- YOU MUST HAND IN A RECEIPT FOR EVERY PURCHASE YOU MAKE.
- Receipts are either left when you return the card or emailed to the OSI Business Manager (leslie.hoffmann@furman.edu)
- Online purchases will need to be made in the Trone Center; do not sign out the card until you are ready to make the purchase.
- If you are making an online purchase and emailing the receipt, please mention your organization in the subject line of the email.
- If you are making an in-person purchase, please pick the card up as close as possible to the time you will be making the purchase; there are many organizations that use the card.
- Please write your organization's name and the event on the receipt.
- You can return the card whenever the Trone Center is open, even on weekends. If the OSI is closed, please ask a Trone desk student staff member to unlock the door for you to return the card.
- Improper use of the credit card will be considered misappropriation of university funds, which may result in disciplinary action including the entire organization losing access to spending. Improper use includes, but is not limited to:
 - using the card for guideline-violating expenses
 - using the card without an approved SyncDIN form
 - using the card for additional purchases that were not approved
 - returning the card without receipts
 - keeping the card for over 24 hours (unless approved)
 - adding the card information to personal accounts
 - taking photos of the card
 - using the card at Amazon or Staples

When you make a purchase, you must return the receipt to OSI when returning the credit card or email the receipt to the OSI Business Manager (leslie.hoffmann@furman.edu); your responsibility does not end until you do this. **All receipts need to include details**- merchant name, date, item description(s) as line items, unit price, quantity, total charge. A credit card slip is not going to be enough detail for a receipt to be accepted. If you are at a restaurant, please request a detailed receipt that shows the food and drinks purchased.

The 25-26 SGA Amazon and Staples Purchase Form

When is the form required? All Amazon and Staples order requests. Please note update for 25-26-Furman no longer allows ANY Amazon or Staples orders outside of the Workday process- NO EXCEPTIONS

Can I still purchase Amazon items and ask for reimbursement? Unfortunately, this is no longer allowed for Amazon and Staples purchases.

Where is this form located? On SyncDIN, Student Government Association (SGA) page.

How far in advance should I fill out the form and submit? At least 10 business days before you need TO RECEIVE the purchase. The reason we need advanced planning is that there are several steps within Workday to place Amazon and Staples orders in addition to shipping time.

Can I just order from Amazon or Staples directly? No, OSI submits all orders via Workday. If you order directly, the credit card will be frozen for all of SGA.

How does OSI know what to order? Once your SyncDIN form is approved, you will need to email the details of what you would like ordered to Leslie Hoffmann at leslie.hoffmann@furman.edu. PLEASE BE SPECIFIC or better, include a link.

How do I know my order has arrived? You will receive an email from student.involvement@furman.edu on the day we receive your order. Please check your emails!

Where do I pick up my order? Please come to the Office of Student Involvement, Suite 206, Trone Center.

The 25-26 SGA Check Form (submit at least 2 weeks prior to needing check)

When is the form required? Checks are much less common than credit card purchases. Use when paying an individual or a company that cannot accept a credit card or charges fees to accept a credit card. Some examples include paying an off-campus venue for a club event, CLP speakers, paying a student for a cash prize, professional services such as **non-Furman** musicians, artists and photographers.

Do I use a check request to pay students? YES if you are paying the student for a cash prize. NO if the student is working for your organization (student musician, artist, photographer). In that case, you would fill out the 25-26 Student Employment Payment Request Form.

Where is this form located? On SyncDIN, Student Government Association (SGA) page.

How far in advance should I fill out the form and submit? At least 12-15 business days BEFORE payment is due.

Why do I have to fill this form out with so much time? Checks are NOT PRINTED AT FURMAN OR IN SOUTH CAROLINA. Also, there are several layers of approvals and processes within Workday that happen after you submit your request.

If you require a check to be given directly to a vendor at the time of an event, we can do this by requesting a check to be mailed back to the University. But you must indicate this when you submit your request on SyncDIN. In this case, please plan to have your check request submitted 3 Thursdays prior to the event date. For example, your event is on Wednesday the 27th...your check request should be submitted no later than Wednesday the 6th. This allows time for the check to be requested, approved, processed, mailed to Furman and then returned to OSI.

What do I have to attach? A check requires a W-9, a contract and/or invoice and possibly a Certificate of Insurance (COI). The student must upload required documents with the request for a check for the approval process to commence.

What is a W-9 (NOT required for Furman students)? A W-9 is a form that Furman needs from the vendor to establish legal name, address, and Tax Identification Number. It is a federal form that most vendors will be familiar with. This is required whether we are paying a person or a company. A person's Tax Identification Number is usually their social security number.

What is a COI (NOT required for Furman students)? A Certificate of Insurance (COI) is going to be required if a vendor comes to Furman and provides a service on campus. It is a form that shows the vendor has insurance and summarized the details of that insurance. **You need to ask the vendor to provide a COI and name Furman University as additionally insured.**

The 25-26 SGA Student Employment Form

When is the form required? This form is only used when paying a student for the professional services provided to your club. Examples include student musicians, photographers, artists, tailors, digital marketers etc.

Isn't this the same as a check request? NO! A check is required for non-Furman professionals or if a student wins a monetary prize. Students who provide services must be paid via payroll. Students will be paid via direct deposit and not check.

Where is this form located? On SyncDIN, Student Government Association (SGA) page.

How far in advance should I fill out the form and submit? At least 12-15 business days BEFORE payment is due.

Why do I have to fill this form out with so much time? If the student is already employed by Furman payment processes more quickly. If not, the process takes longer.

WHEN HIRING A STUDENT, YOU MUST ASK THEM IF THEY ARE ALREADY EMPLOYED AT FURMAN BEFORE THEY WORK. IF THEY ARE NOT EMPLOYED BY FURMAN, THEY NEED TO PRESENT I-9 DOCUMENTS TO ENROLLMENT SERVICES FIRST:

- **This is a FEDERAL LAW!**
- **Student needs to provide original documents NO COPIES**
- **If the student has an unexpired passport, that is all they need.**
- **No Passport? Need 2 documents: original driver's license or State ID AND social security card or birth certificate.**
- **Enrollment Services is on the first floor of the Administration Building (where Admissions is)**
- **The student should say the Leslie Hoffmann is the Hiring Manager**

The 25-26 SGA Student Reimbursement Form

Please plan for your expenses! Reimbursements should not be the norm, please only utilize as a last resort or there is a time constraint. SGA cannot guarantee payment of a reimbursement.

Please note three key facts:

- Reimbursements can only be issued to current Furman students-not advisors, affiliates, coaches, or external entities.
- Students need to complete reimbursement requests within 30 days of occurrence.
- **Students need to present detailed receipts that show that payment was made via their own credit card or cash.** An email with an order summary, for example, which does not show payment method, will not be approved.
- It is best to use the SGA credit card to pay for conference registrations and air travel whenever possible. If you pay on your personal card, it will be reimbursed after travel has occurred.
- Students who drive to an event on behalf of a club or organization can request mileage reimbursement, for travel to and from campus, currently **50 cents** a mile. The request should include the following:
 - Event information (where and what was purpose)
 - Dates of travel
 - Mileage detail (screenshots of google maps required!)
 - Gas purchases are not reimbursed-mileage reimbursement encompasses fuel, and vehicle maintenance.
 - **Important Update for 25-26: Student mileage reimbursements cannot be processed unless the student attend the online FUPD defensive driving course and undergo a driver's background check. Please contact the OSI Business**

Manager with the student names BEFORE driving occurs or reimbursement will not be processed

- Student Organizations traveling in conjunction with the hosting of an off-campus event or program must follow all event registration procedures established by the Office of Student Involvement.
 - **Domestic.** Student Organizations must register travel within the continental United States through the Office of Student Involvement at least seven days prior to the proposed trip and provide a complete itinerary of all events that would be considered student organization activity, to receive travel authorization. Domestic travel endorsed, arranged, and led by Athletics, Academic Affairs, Academic Departments and Programs, and Student Life is exempt from this policy.
 - **International.** Any student organization traveling outside of the continental United States must contact the Rinker Center for Study Away and International Education at least thirty days prior to travel to receive authorization. Authorization will not be granted for events that the University determines are primarily social in nature as opposed to educational, professional development, competition, performance, service, or similar.
 - **Exceptions:** Exceptions to this policy will be reviewed by the Office of Student Involvement, in consultation with appropriate university officials.
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